SIGNAL OFFICER ADVANCE COURSE • SUBJECT 3.1 TROOP LEADING PROCEDURE

SAMPLE GROUP PRESENTATION

Practice Scenario — Exercise TANGLAW PASS (defense)

A worked example to study alongside Student Handout 3.1, in preparation for the Graded Practical Exercise.

HOW TO USE THIS SAMPLE

- **Try the scenario first.** Work the Practice Scenario packet in 2 hours, as you will in the GPE.
- **Then compare.** Slides 4–13 show the 10 slides a strong group would present.
- **Read the study notes** on each slide: why it works, what to avoid, and where it is in the Student Handout.
- **One acceptable answer.** Your plan may differ and still be correct — what matters is that it follows from your analysis and from the higher order.

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE n OF 10
What the group presents

STUDY NOTES
Why it works; what to avoid

Handout: Part / Step
Where to read more

TLP IN THE DEFENSE — WHAT CHANGES?

TLP step	Offense (attack)	Defense (this scenario)
1–2 Time and WARNO	Time runs to the LD / attack time	Time runs to "defense prepared" — and every hour of digging counts
3 Tentative plan	Decisive point is often on the objective	Decisive point is usually the engagement area where obstacles and fires mass
4 Initiate movement	Move to the attack position	**Move to the sector early** — before the plan is finished — to start priorities of work
5 Reconnaissance	Look at the objective from our side	Walk the engagement area **from the enemy's side** (PAM 3-0101-04, Annex A)
6–7 Complete / issue	Assault, support, breach	Battle positions, sectors of fire, obstacles, FPF, OP withdrawal
8 Supervise / refine	Rehearse the assault	Check positions, fields of fire and wire; rehearse the fight; **stand-to at BMNT**

The eight steps are the same; what fills them changes. Expect either an offensive or a defensive mission in the GPE.

GROUP 1 — B COMPANY, 2EB

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 1 OF 10

Role	Member	Responsible for
Company Commander	Member 1	Leads TLP; selects COA; issues order
Executive Officer	Member 2	Timeline; Class IV/V; CASEVAC; backbrief
1st PLT Leader	Member 3	Terrain and obstacle plan; OP
2nd PLT Leader	Member 4	Enemy analysis; anti-armor plan
3rd PLT Leader	Member 5	War-game; depth position
Fires / Comms	Member 6	Fire plan, FPF; wire and PACE; paragraph 5

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Each role produces a part of the plan.
- ✓ The presenter is picked at random — rehearse so anyone can brief every slide.

AVOID

- ✗ One member builds every slide.

Handout: Part IX, GPE products

STEP 1 — PLANNING TIMELINE

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 2 OF 10

WARNO D-1 1000H → defense prepared D 0400H = 18 hrs. ⅓ = 6 hrs → Co OPORD NLT 1600H (planned 1500H)

Time	Event	Time	Event
1015	Co WARNO 1	1700	CO backbrief to BN
1030	Leader's recon of sector	1800	BN rehearsal
1200	Receive BN OPORD	1900	Co rock drill + fires/obstacle rehearsal
1230	Co WARNO 2	2000	OP on Hill 310; R1 on BN order
1300	**Company moves to sector**	2200	PCIs; wire and radio checks
1400	Priorities of work begin	0400	Defense prepared
1500	Co OPORD at BP2; Class IV arrives	0430	Stand-to through BMNT 0508
1600	PL backbriefs with sector sketches		

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Reverse-planned from 0400H, the BN's "defense prepared" time.
- ✓ Company moves at 1300H, before the order is issued — in the defense, time on the ground is everything.
- ✓ BN deadlines (1700 backbrief, 1800 rehearsal, 2000 evacuation) included.

AVOID

- ✗ Waiting for a finished plan before moving.
- ✗ Forgetting the stand-to.

Handout: Part III, Step 1; Part VIII

STEP 2 — COMPANY WARNO

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 3 OF 10

Issued D-1 1015H — 15 minutes after the BN WARNO

Item	Content
Mission / nature	B Co defends Daang Pasong astride Route 7 NLT D 0400H to stop the OPFOR advance toward Malaya
OPORD time / place	1500H at BP2 (GD 656 446), on the ground overlooking the engagement area
Participating	All PLTs, weapons section; engineer squad, FO team, 2 x 90-mm RR teams (arrive 1400H)
Tasks not in SOP	PLs and PSGs join CO for sector recon at 1030H; 1st PLT designates the OP squad; 1SG draws Class V; prepare to move at 1300H
Timeline	As per Step 1; defense prepared 0400H

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Out fast — subordinates can start moving and preparing at once.
- ✓ Names the place of the OPORD on the ground.
- ✓ Gives the OP task early so the squad can plan.

AVOID

- ✗ A WARNO that only repeats the BN WARNO.

Handout: Part III, Step 2

STEP 3 — MISSION ANALYSIS

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 4 OF 10

	Analysis
Higher intent	Destroy OPFOR at the pass mouth • no penetration of PL STEEL • protect CPs and relay • no civilian casualties
Specified	Defend Sector B NLT 0400 • destroy OPFOR in EA KAMAO • OP on Hill 310 from 2000 • close R1 on order • tie in at CP1/CP2
Implied	Cover Sapa Tuyo • anti-armor on Route 7 • integrate obstacles with fires • OP withdrawal • counter-recon from 0100 • camouflage and emission control • lay wire
Essential	Destroy OPFOR in EA KAMAO
Constraints	Route 7 open until 2000 • R1 only on BN order • no mines • RFA Brgy Pasong • Class IV only at 1500

RESTATED MISSION: B Co, 2EB defends Sector B (Daang Pasong) NLT D 0400H to destroy OPFOR forces in EA KAMAO in order to prevent the OPFOR from passing through the pass toward Malaya and the TANGLAW relay.

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Purpose comes from the BN mission and intent — nested.
- ✓ Implied tasks are real work the order did not spell out.
- ✓ Constraints include time limits (Route 7 until 2000) and the RFA.

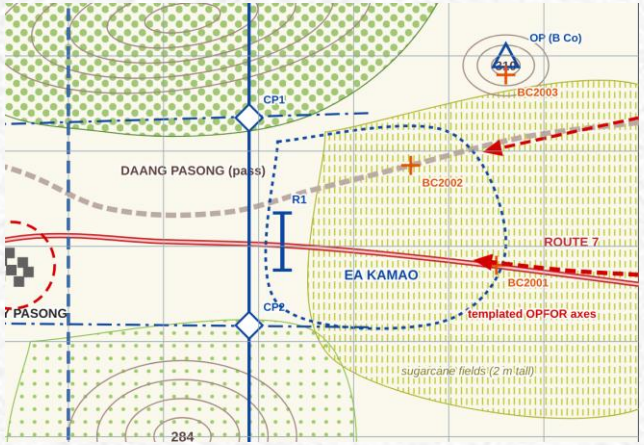
AVOID

- ✗ "B Co defends the pass" — no purpose, no time.
- ✗ Listing SOP items as implied tasks.

Handout: Part III Step 3; Part IV (Mission)

STEP 3 — METT-TC DEDUCTIONS

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 5 OF 10



Enemy MPCOA: recon in Sapa Tuyo 0100–0400; drone at BMNT; mortars on emitters; technicals on Route 7 + platoon in the creek about 0530

- **Terrain:** two avenues converge at the pass mouth → EA KAMAO. Creek bed = covered dismounted approach.
- **Cane** hides the enemy to ~800 m → engage there with indirect fire.
- **Weather:** east wind blows smoke at us; 64% moon helps both sides.
- **Troops:** 2nd PLT anti-armor → ME with RRs, but PSG is acting PL.
- **Time:** wire only at 1500 → obstacle work at night.
- **Civil:** 30 people in RFA; Route 7 open to 2000.

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Every fact turns into a "so what" for the plan.
- ✓ Enemy MPCOA in a sketch, with times.
- ✓ Spots the leader issue in 2nd PLT.

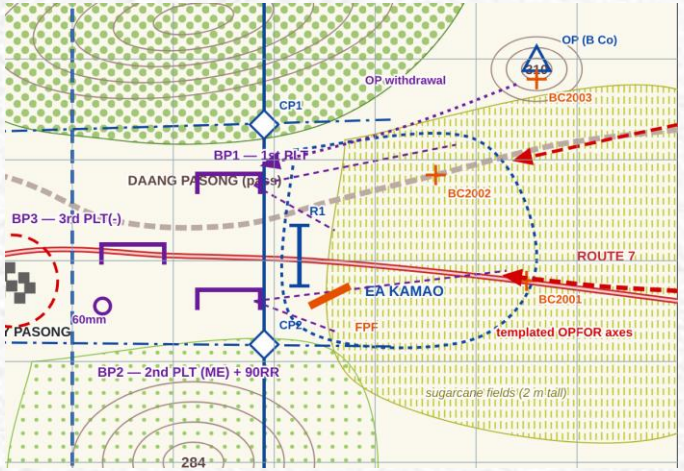
AVOID

- ✗ Copying the OAKOC definitions.
- ✗ No enemy sketch.

Handout: Part IV; Part V, Estimate Step 2

STEP 3 — COA 1

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 6 OF 10



Decisive point: EA KAMAO at R1 (GD 662 450), where Route 7 and Sapa Tuyo converge — obstacle, direct and indirect fire mass there.

- **2nd PLT (ME) + 90RR** BP2: destroy technicals and lead elements at R1.
- **1st PLT (SE1)** BP1: destroy the creek element so it cannot flank the ME.
- **3rd PLT(-) (SE2)** BP3 in depth: block penetration of PL STEEL.
- **OP squad** Hill 310; **60-mm** GD 643 446; **FPF** in front of BP2.

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Decisive point is where the enemy will be destroyed — and why.
- ✓ Task and purpose for every element; SE purposes protect the ME.
- ✓ Depth (BP3) guards against penetration.
- ✓ COA 2 (three on line) was considered and rejected.

AVOID

- ✗ Battle positions with no sectors of fire.
- ✗ Fires planned into the RFA.

Handout: Part V; Part III Step 3b

STEP 3 — WAR-GAME

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 7 OF 10

Avenue-in-depth technique:

- Recon in creek → OP reports, withdraws (UWI)
- Drone at BMNT → camouflage, emission control
- Mortars on emitters → remote antennas, wire
- Technicals hit R1 → 90RR + BC2001
- Creek platoon flanks → BP1 + BC2002
- Penetration → BP3 blocks; BN reserve

Factor	COA1	COA2
Depth	1	2
Mass at EA	1	2
Creek coverage	1	2
Simplicity	2	1
Obstacle integration	1	1
Survivability	1	2
TOTAL	7	10

DECISION: COA 1 (two up, one back)

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Avenue-in-depth suits a defense with two avenues (Part V).
- ✓ Each critical event has a counteraction in the plan.
- ✓ The matrix supports — the commander decides.

AVOID

- ✗ War-game skipped.
- ✗ Factors that have nothing to do with the war-game.

Handout: Part V, Estimate Steps 3–4

STEPS 4–5 — MOVE AND RECON

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 8 OF 10

Information gap	How confirmed	By / when
Fields of fire from BP1/BP2 into EA	Walk the positions; mark limits	CO + PLs, 1030H
Dead space in Sapa Tuyo	Walk the creek from the enemy side	1st PL, 1100H
Where the cane stops (engagement distance)	Pace from PL IRON to cane edge	2nd PL, 1100H
R1 site and bypasses	Engineer squad leader recon	Engr SL, 1430H
OP site and withdrawal route	OP squad leader recon	OP SL, 1600H

- **Movement:** company moves to sector 1300H; OP moves 1930H to be in place by 2000H.

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Recon looks at the EA from the enemy's side (Annex A, defensive analysis).
- ✓ Movement starts early — Step 4 does not wait for Step 3 to finish.
- ✓ Every recon task answers a specific gap.

AVOID

- ✗ "Conduct recon" with no purpose.

Handout: Part III Steps 4–5

STEPS 6–7 — OPORD SUMMARY

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 9 OF 10

Para	Key content
1. Situation	OPFOR MPCOA and sketch; A Co north, C Co south, BN reserve; attachments
2. Mission	Restated mission (slide 4)
3. Execution	Intent; COA 1; fires BC2001–2003, FPF (red star); R1 closed on BN order (SARADO); OP withdrawal (UWI); priorities of work
4. Sustainment	Class IV/V at 1500; CCP GD 638 452; resupply by night
5. Cmd & Signal	P: field wire to BPs • A: Co VHF B2 • C: messengers • E: pyro/whistle • antennas remoted; KIDLAT drill

In the defense, wire is primary: it cannot be direction-found, and the OPFOR has mortared emitters before.

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Paragraph 5 is a real company plan, matched to the enemy's DF threat — this is where Signal officers shine.
- ✓ Obstacles, fires and battle positions are tied together.
- ✓ Code words and pyro signals used in the plan.

AVOID

- ✗ Copying the BN CEOI as paragraph 5.
- ✗ Radio as primary when the enemy hunts emitters.

Handout: Part VI (Signal leader); Part VII

STEP 8 — SUPERVISE AND REFINE

SAMPLE GROUP SLIDE 10 OF 10

Time	Activity	Purpose
1400H→	Priorities of work: security, positions, fields of fire, obstacles, wire, dig	Build the defense in order
1600H	PL backbriefs with sector sketches	Check mutual support and gaps
1900H	Rock drill + fires/obstacle support rehearsal	OP withdrawal, R1 closure, FPF signal
2200H	PCIs; wire and radio checks	Confirm PACE works
2300H	CO walks the line	Check from the enemy's side
0430H	Stand-to through BMNT (0508H)	Ready at the expected attack time

STUDY NOTES — WHY THIS WORKS

- ✓ Priorities of work listed in order.
- ✓ Rehearsal type and method named; focused on critical events.
- ✓ Leaders check positions themselves (PCI).

AVOID

- ✗ "We will rehearse" with no type or focus.

Handout: Part III Step 8; Part VIII

HOW THE GPE WILL BE SCORED

Part	What the panel looks for	Points
1. Content	Correct TLP steps; sound analysis of the scenario; your own field experience; insight into the real problems	40
2. Organization and Structure	Clear slides; logical TLP sequence	20
3. Team Collaboration	Everyone contributes; slides agree with each other	20
4. Presentation Skills	Confident delivery; good sketches and visual aids	20
5. Engagement and Response	Involves the audience; answers questions using your own plan	10

PRESENTING TIPS

BEFORE

- Rehearse once — anyone may be picked
- Check times match on every slide
- One requirement per slide

DURING

- Brief it like an order
- Use the map — walk the plan
- Stay within 15 minutes

QUESTIONS

- Answer from your plan: intent, PACE, fires
- If the situation changes, say what you'd do and who you'd tell
- It's fine to say "we assumed…"

CHECKLIST BEFORE THE GPE

- I can list the eight steps and say which run continuously
- I can apply the ⅓ – ⅔ rule and reverse-plan
- I can write a restated mission with a purpose
- I can name and justify a decisive point
- I can write a COA statement with task and purpose for each element
- I can pick a war-game technique
- I can build a PACE plan that fits the enemy threat
- I can name the rehearsal types and methods